



SOP · V1.0 · INSTRUCTORS

Live Builder Session **Guide.**

The minimum structure every builder session needs.

Instructors stay flexible inside the guardrails. Members know exactly what to expect — and leave with something they built, not something they watched.

THE ONE-LINE PROMISE TO MEMBERS

Show up with the pre-reqs done, and you will build a working thing in the next 60 to 90 minutes.

60–90 min

SESSION LENGTH

2+

CHECKPOINTS (FLOOR)

24h

PRE-REQS LEAD TIME



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What's in this document.

A tight, seven-part SOP. Read the promise, then the structure, then the quality bar.
The rest is how we hit it.

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PURPOSE

Builder sessions are hands-on. **Members should leave with something they built, not something they watched.** This SOP sets the minimum structure every session needs so instructors stay flexible inside the guardrails and members know exactly what to expect.



01 · T MINUS 24 HOURS

Before the session.

Instructor posts once in Slack **#all-grc-eng-club** and forwards to **#live-sessions**. That's the whole comms plan. If the post doesn't go out 24 hours before, the session is postponed. No exceptions.

THE PRE-SESSION POST MUST INCLUDE

- 1 Session title and learning outcome.** One sentence.
e.g. "By the end you will have a working Lambda that flags S3 buckets missing encryption."
- 2 Pre-reqs checklist,** explicit and testable.
Accounts / access needed (AWS, GitHub, etc.) · Tools installed (CLI, IDE, runtime versions) · Any starter repo cloned, with a "you are ready if you can run X" smoke test.
- 3 Session time.**
Zoom link goes out **day of**, posted in **#live-sessions** — not in this pre-session post. Note that the instructor will be on camera. Members welcome on camera but not required.
- 4 What we will build,** with a screenshot or diagram of the end state.



Comms plan: **post in #all-grc-eng-club**, then **forward to #live-sessions**.
Zoom link drops in **#live-sessions the day of**. No emails, no Discord.

02 · MEMBER EXPECTATIONS

State them twice.

Once at registration. Again in the first two minutes of the session. Do not assume people read the email.

INSTRUCTOR ON CAMERA

Members optional. Camera on is encouraged but never required for members.

PRE-REQS DONE

Before joining. We will not burn the first 20 minutes on environment setup.

BUILD ALONG

Laptop open, terminal ready. Not just listening.

QUESTIONS WELCOME

In chat any time. Answered at the next checkpoint.



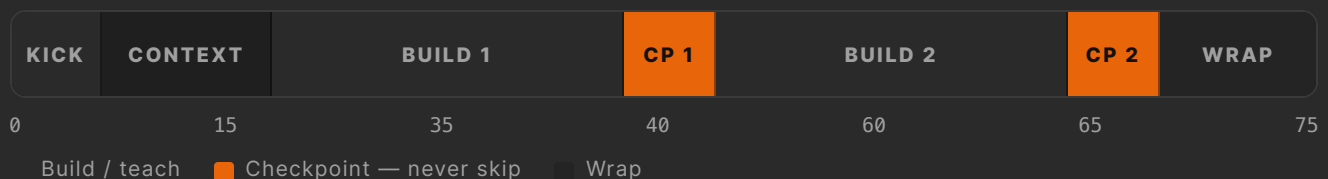
03 · 60 TO 90 MINUTES

Session structure.

The instructor owns the content inside these blocks. The blocks are the guardrails. Two checkpoints is the floor. Add a third for longer sessions. Never skip them.

BLOCK	TIME	WHAT HAPPENS
Kickoff	0 – 5 min	Instructor camera on, restate outcome, confirm everyone passed the pre-req smoke test.
Context	5 – 15 min	Why this matters, the pattern we are learning, the end-state demo.
Build block 1	15 – 35 min	Instructor builds live. Members follow. Ends at a checkpoint.
Checkpoint 1	CHECKPOINT 35 – 40 min	Everyone shares "I am at step X" in chat. Answer questions. Unstick anyone behind.
Build block 2	40 – 60 min	Next chunk. Same pattern.
Checkpoint 2	CHECKPOINT 60 – 65 min	Same as above.
Wrap	65 – 75 min	Run the final thing end to end. Share the repo / artifact link. Name the next session.

SESSION RHYTHM AT A GLANCE





04 · FLEXIBILITY INSIDE THE GUARDRAILS

Teach your way. Don't break the shape.

You own the content. The guardrails stay. Here's what's negotiable and what's not.

✓ INSTRUCTORS CAN

- Teach in whatever style you want — top-down, demo-first, Socratic, whatever works.
- Go deeper on one block and shorter on another, as long as **checkpoints still happen**.
- Drop a planned **stretch goal** if the room is behind.
- Bring guests, side tangents, war stories, opinions.

✗ INSTRUCTORS SHOULD NOT

- Skip the pre-req email.
- Skip checkpoints.
- Let the session become a **lecture with slides and no building**.
- Spend more than **5 minutes** debugging one person's environment on the main call — pair them off or take it after.



The blocks are the shape of the session. Your voice, your content, your pacing — **that's the session itself.**

FIELD NOTES

- If **more than a third of the room** is 🟡 or 🔴, stop the build and regroup. Do not push forward.
- If you're teaching a topic for the first time, **scope for 60 min of content in a 75-min slot**. Leave room to unstick.
- Pair-off is a first-class move. A second instructor in a breakout room saves more sessions than any amount of troubleshooting on the main call.



05 · THE PART THAT'S BEEN BREAKING

Three habits. Do all three.

This is the failure mode the SOP was written to fix. Pick these up and the session gets measurably better the same week.

HABIT 01

Say the checkpoint out loud before you start the block.

"In the next 20 minutes we are going to end with the Lambda deployed and returning 200. If you are not there when I say time, drop a 🟡 in chat."

HABIT 02

Use chat reactions as a pulse check.

Three reactions. Nothing else. Glance at the counts every 10 minutes.

HABIT 03

Commit to git at every checkpoint.

Post the commit SHA or branch in chat so anyone behind can `git checkout` and rejoin.

THE THREE-REACTION PULSE

**FOLLOWING**

On the current step. No blockers. Keep moving.

**BEHIND**

Not at the checkpoint yet. Flag it, catch up at the next break.

**STUCK**

Actively blocked. Needs a co-instructor or pair-off to unblock.

1/3

If **more than a third of the room** is 🟡 or 🔴, stop the build and regroup. Do not push forward.



06 · HANDOFF, NOT HOMEWORK

After the session.

You don't own the recording post — **club leadership does**. You own the artifact and the recap. Keep it tight.

01 · RECORDING

Send the raw recording to **Abdie or AJ**. Club leadership handles posting — not you, not within 24 hours.

02 · ARTIFACT

Final repo / artifact link — with the **branch or tag** used in the session. Post in #live-sessions.

03 · RECAP

One paragraph in #live-sessions. What we built, what's next session.

07 · QUALITY BAR

Four questions. One answer each.

A session is "good" if we can answer **yes** to all four. Three out of four is a miss. Own it in the next instructor sync and adjust.



Was the instructor on camera the whole session?

Q1 · PRESENCE



Did members leave with a working artifact they built themselves?

Q2 · OUTCOME



Did we hit every checkpoint?

Q3 · STRUCTURE



Did the repo link & recap go out in #live-sessions, and the recording get to Abdie or AJ?

Q4 · FOLLOW-THROUGH

END OF DOCUMENT

Stop scrolling. Start engineering.

BUILDER SESSION SOP · V1.0

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